

Part 1

Read Passage One and answer questions 1-7 on the Question-Answer Book.

Passage One:

5 health tips to help prevent eye strain during online learning

- 1 [1] Online learning has meant you could pursue your studies in the comfort of your own home. But it might not have been very comfortable to stare at your screen for hours every day.
- [2] Have you ever felt that your eyes feel sore, burning or itchy? Or maybe you've had a headache, blurred vision or neck pain, or felt that you could not keep your eyes open. If you've felt any of these things, you may be suffering from computer vision syndrome, or digital eye strain. The condition is very common nowadays with studying and working from home. But you don't have to suffer. Young Post asked Dr Fiona Luk Oi-jing for some tips to help prevent the condition. Luk is an ~~ophthalmologist~~ – a doctor who treats eye diseases – at the Premier Medical Centre in Central.
- 5 [3] You may think that humans blink naturally. But researchers have found that we blink less than half as often as usual when we are focused on a screen. But blinking is crucial.
- 10 [4] "Blinking helps to distribute our tears evenly on our eye surface," says Luk. "It can prevent our eyes from getting dry and help to maintain good vision." Make an effort to blink intentionally every 20-30 minutes, to make sure it's happening.
- [5] If you close your curtains and don't turn on the light in your room, there will be a big contrast between the light on your computer screen or other digital device, and the light around you. This can really harm our eyes.
- 15 [6] "Very strong light can damage our retina. Ambient light [general lighting] is more important than the lighting on the screen," Luk says, "and make sure that your room is well lit when you're on your phone or computer to avoid straining your eyes."
- [7] Luk recommends taking frequent breaks – at least a 20- to 30-second break every 20 to 30 minutes. During this time, she says, you should look at a distant object out of your window – for example, a car on a flyover or a bird in the sky. This helps your eye muscles to relax. And while doing jumping jacks won't help your eye health, there are some moves that can.
- 20 [8] First, the eye roll. Close your eyes and roll them in circles. Repeat this move five to 10 times in each direction. Second, look at an object that is far away, then at something that is closer. Repeat this a few times.
- [9] While Luk says: "There is no evidence that blue light glasses can protect our eyesight," she adds that they do make our eyes less tired by easing eye strain when looking at a screen. You can find them at optical shops.
- 25 [10] Be aware, though, that there is also no scientific evidence that wearing blue-light glasses when using a computer prevents your short-sightedness from getting worse, Luk adds.
- [11] It's important that your face isn't too close to the screen, Luk says. "Students should maintain a distance of at least 30cm from books or tablets, and a minimum distance of 50cm from desktop computers. If students are too close to the computer screen, they will be straining their eye muscles. This can cause myopia." Therefore, it is also important to keep your screen below eye level.
- 30

Read Passage Two and answer questions 8-12 on the Question-Answer Book.

Passage Two:

Hong Kong's government gives refugees HK\$50 a day for food and transport – what is that like?

- 1 [1] With only HK\$50 in my pocket, I did not have many options for food especially when I needed to use some of it for transport. I am not from an underprivileged family. But last month, after hearing about the financial plight of Hong Kong's 13,000 refugees, I decided to try stepping into their shoes.
- 5 [2] The city's refugees are given a government subsidy of HK\$3,000 (US\$386) a month. Half must be used for rent. The remaining half leaves refugees with about HK\$50 (US\$6) to spend on food, transport and other expenses every day. This is not much since food in Hong Kong costs anywhere from HK\$30 at a cha chaan teng to HK\$800 at a buffet. And that was the amount I set for my challenge.
- 10 [3] The first difficulty I faced was getting breakfast. With not a lot of money in my pocket, I decided to just skip it and went straight to work. I could have spent two hours hiking from my home in Pok Fu Lam, through the Lung Fu Shan Country Park, to Young Post's office in Causeway Bay. But I decided the HK\$5.50 bus fare would be a much easier journey.
- 15 [4] Since I would need to spend another HK\$5.50 to return home, I had HK\$39 left for my lunch and dinner. The night before, I went shopping at the supermarket. I spent HK\$4.90 on mushrooms, HK\$13 on two aubergines, HK\$4.80 on one pack of instant noodles, and HK\$15.90 on a can of diced pork. While the food I cooked with these ingredients did not look great, it was tasty and nutritious enough. But if I continued eating like this, the processed food would likely hurt my health.
- [5] To get home from Causeway Bay, I did not have enough money to ride a HK\$6.80 bus from Times Square. Instead, I walked 1.5km to catch a HK\$5.50 bus. Two full buses passed me at the bus stop. But finally, 43 minutes after I had left Times Square, I managed to squeeze on the third one, squished against the windscreen.
- 20 [6] In the end, I would not say that I really experienced the challenges that refugees face. My choice to do this challenge was exactly that – a choice. At any point, I could have stopped if I had chosen to. I ate well the day before the challenge, and I knew I would eat well the day after.
- 25 [7] Asylum Action is a student group that organises challenges like the one I did. It was founded two years ago by Vania Chow, a student at Li Po Chun United World College. Growing up, she heard of how difficult life was for her grandparents who left the mainland for Hong Kong, but she knew little about present day refugees. "I always knew [refugees] existed, but they were numbers I would see on a government report," Vania said.
- [8] Before creating Asylum Action, Vania, now 17, volunteered at Run, an NGO focused on refugee health. There, she met a refugee volunteer, who told stories about her daily life and struggles. This inspired Vania to raise awareness about the small stipends refugees are given in Hong Kong.
- 30 [9] Eunice Lau, a 15-year-old student from Renaissance College, took part in one of Asylum Action's challenges where she lived on a HK\$50 daily budget for three days. She skipped breakfast to save money, but her cup noodle diet had her feeling drained by the end of the second day. At the supermarket, she wanted a box of nutritious salad so badly. But she had no choice but to move on to the next aisle to find something cheaper.
- 35 [10] "I was worried if I was even going to successfully finish this challenge," she said. Money was a constant worry, she explained, and her groceries went over budget a few times. At the end of the challenge, Eunice was so moved that she became a student ambassador for Asylum Action.

END OF READING PASSAGES

**FORM 2****GENERAL ENGLISH****QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK**

Name: _____

Class: _____

Class Number: _____

Set 2**Part 1 – Reading Comprehension (30 marks)****For each multiple-choice question, darken the appropriate circle. Otherwise, no mark will be awarded.****Passage One (17 marks)**

1. Using paragraph 2, name two possible symptoms of computer vision syndrome. (2 marks)

2. Find a word in paragraphs 3 to 7 which shares the same meaning as each of the phrases below. (3 marks)

- (i) very important _____
- (ii) on purpose _____
- (iii) far away _____

3. What is the meaning of “jumping jacks”? Make a guess and explain your answer.

4. According to Dr Luk, what is the benefit of using blue-light glasses?

5. What condition can people experience if they sit too close to the screens of their electronic devices?

6. Use the information in the article to decide whether the following statements are True, False or Not Given. (4 marks)

- | | T | F | NG |
|--|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| (i) Dr Luk works at an optical shop. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| (ii) We blink less often when we are reading. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| (iii) We should lower the brightness of our electronic devices because a bright screen is harmful to our eyes. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| (iv) We should keep our screen above eye level. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

7. Match the headings to the text. Write the letters (A-F) next to the matching paragraph numbers. One heading is not used. (5 marks)

Heading
A. Keep your distance
B. Try blue-light glasses
C. Keep it bright
D. Try blinking less
E. Blink more often
F. Take a break, and get a move on

Paragraph
3
5
7
9
11

E
C
F
B
A

Passage Two (13 marks)

8. According to paragraphs 1 to 5, how much did the author spend for this challenge?

9. According to paragraphs 3 to 5, how did the author commute from Causeway Bay to his or her home?

10. Match each of the following comments with a person or organisation mentioned in the text. Write the letter of the comment next to the person/ organisation given. One comment is **NOT** used. Each letter can be used **ONCE** only. (3 marks)

- A. We care about refugees in Hong Kong, especially their physical and mental wellbeing.
 B. I have around \$50 per day to live on because I need to save the rest for housing payment.
 C. We are an NGO run by a group of young volunteers who organise budget challenges.
 D. I am sure my health would deteriorate if I kept eating processed food like instant noodles every day.
 E. We offer help by giving stipends to the refugees in Hong Kong.

Asylum Action e.g.	C	(i) Yvette (the author)	
(ii) Refugees in Hong Kong		(iii) Run	

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

11. Below is a summary of Yvette (the author) and Eunice's budget challenge. In three of the lines there is **ONE** mistake. If you find a mistake, underline it and replace the word with one that expresses the correct idea. Write the word in the box on the right. Both grammar and spelling must be correct. In one of the lines there is no mistake; put a tick (✓) in the box. One has been done for you as an example. (4 marks)

	Summary	Correction
(i)	Yvette and Eunice participated in a challenge to live on a HK\$50 annual budget.	
(ii)	However, their challenges had different durations. Yvette lived on that budget for a day,	
(iii)	while Eunice lived on it for two days. Given their tight budgets, the girls decided to skip	
(iv)	breakfast. To save money, they bought fresh food, like instant noodles and canned pork,	
e.g.	for other meals. Eunice was <u>doubtless</u> if she would successfully finish the challenge.	doubtful

12. Tiffany is writing an article on non-governmental organisations in Hong Kong. Please help her complete the following paragraph. Use only **ONE** word in each blank. Make sure your answers are grammatically correct. (4 marks)

Two years ago, Vania Chow (i) _____ Asylum Action after (ii) _____ at Run.
 Although she is only a (iii) _____, she is pursuing the mission of raising public
 (iv) _____ about the challenges that refugees in Hong Kong face every day.

END OF PART 1

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Part 2 – English Usage (70 marks)

A. Verb Forms (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the words provided in brackets in their correct forms.

It was November 15, 2003, only a few weeks before the star (1) (pass) away. Now, 18 years later, Mui's legend lives on with her biopic *Anita*, which (2) (release) next Friday.

Directed by the award-winning Longmond Leung Lok-man, the film traces the rise and fall of Mui (played by Louise Wong), and portrays the golden era of Hong Kong entertainment. It (3) (open) with Mui stepping on stage for the last time and looking back at her life.

With a career that began at the age of four, the singer (4) (rise) to fame after winning a singing competition in 1982. She later met her lifelong best friends, stylist Eddie Lau Pui-kei (played by Louis Koo Tin-lok) and superstar Leslie Cheung Kwok-wing (played by Terrance Lau Chun-him).

Groundbreaking songs like *Debt Heart* (1982), *Red* (1983), and *Bad Girl* (1985), helped propel Mui to stardom. In 1985, she fell in love with a Japanese singer, but sadly, their relationship didn't last.

The end of this relationship illustrated Mui's biggest wish – (5) (spend) the rest of her life with someone she loved. The artist then dedicated herself to the stage and successfully kicked off a career as an actress.

One stand-out scene shows one of the biggest turning points in her career. In 1992, Mui angered a gang boss and was forced to hide in Thailand for a year. Although it was a heavy blow, it also led her in a new direction and gave her a new goal in life.

After returning to Hong Kong, Mui devoted herself to (6) (volunteer) and charitable work and became a social activist, giving meal boxes to the homeless, building schools in mainland China and raising funds for underprivileged people.

Another particularly moving scene is when the people in Hong Kong united (7) (show) support for each other during the SARS epidemic in 2003. Even though Mui (8) (suffer) from cervical cancer, she still insisted on (9) (organise) the "1:99 Concert" at Hong Kong Stadium to cheer on medical staff and raise money for the children of SARS victims.

The movie (10) (end) with a return to the first scene, with Mui wearing a white wedding gown designed by her friend Eddie Lau and rising to the stage to perform her anthem *Song of the Sunset*. Surrounded by 10,000 fans, the star slowly climbed the steps to a church door, waving her hands to bid a final farewell.

All in all, the movie tells a splendid story about Mui and reflects the city's lion rock spirit of perseverance and solidarity. The crew also did a great job of recreating Hong Kong in the 80s and 90s, including landmarks like Millie shopping centre, Park Lai Yuen amusement park, and Lee Theatre.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

B. Vocabulary (5 marks)

Choose the most suitable words from the table below to complete the sentences. Each word should only be used once.

rejected	high spirits	annually
assistant	released	incredibly
monthly	gorgeous	fatigue

Allison is anxiously holding an envelope. The results of her application were (1) this morning and the letter has just arrived. If her application is successful, she will be the (2) to the CEO. This company recruits for new employees (3), so she will have to wait for another 12 months if her application is rejected.

"I got the job!" exclaims Allison, "The hiring managers said I did a(n) (4) good job at interview, and I would be an asset to the company." Everyone is excited for her, and they are all in (5).

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

C. Parts of Speech (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate forms of the words in brackets.

If you have any (1) (want) items, why not donate them to local (2) (charitable)? Greenwich Community Centre is currently recruiting (3) (voluntary). They will be organising a swap event where you can find a lot of second-hand clothes, toys and kitchen utensils. I'm sure it will (4) (attractive) many participants!

Regarding the condition of the items, they must be (5) (full) functional. You can bring them to the centre a week prior to the event, or (6) (simple) bring them along to the event. During the event, (7) (compliments) snacks and tea will be provided. There will also be a live band to (8) (entertaining) the guests by performing some of their (9) (originally) songs.

What are you waiting for? Act now and (10) (contribution) to environmental protection!

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

D. Phrasal Verbs (5 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the phrasal verbs provided in the table below. You may need to change the form of the verbs. Each phrase can be used once only.

fall over	bring about	call off	fall into
cut back	cut up	come up with	bring up

Smart Choices?

Smartphones are undoubtedly convenient, but the world of possibilities that they offer young people carries a hefty amount of responsibility and requires them to exercise both self-control and good judgment. Are the kids up to it?

Smartphones enable us to access the internet anytime, anywhere. As a result of such ease of access, people are getting more and more attached to their mobile electronic gadgets. Spending too much time on these devices can disrupt life, and that is happening to many people. Some, especially young people, may even become addicted to their devices.

Students hooked on their gadgets may find their grades suffering. Their relationships with friends and family can deteriorate as they obsess over their digital world to the exclusion of everything else. Some hide their 'screen addiction' from their parents, teachers and friends. Attempts to (1) on screen time are often unsuccessful. Some will become reclusive, preferring the virtual world to the real one, and may (2) plans with their peers just to spend more time in digital space. Prolonged usage of computers or other digital devices can cause a host of health problems, including hurting the eyes and straining muscles and tendons.

If youngsters (3) the habit of spending long hours on mobile devices, they may experience shortened attention spans or even delayed speech development. Frequent computer use often (4) a sedentary lifestyle, which increases the risk of conditions like obesity and heart disease. It is important for us to (5) ways to maintain a healthy lifestyle.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

E. Verb + Infinitive or -ing Form (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the words in brackets in their correct forms.

What do you regret spending your red packet money on?

Since my sister's birthday was around the corner, I was considering (1) (buy) her a gift. However, I looked into my wallet and realised I had spent all my lai see on food. I ended up (2) (have) to save my pocket money for her present.

Daisy

Last year, I bought my brother a mystery snacks box on Instagram because he is a foodie. The packaging does not allow buyers (3) (see) what is inside. They claimed that the snacks were their bestsellers. When we opened the box, most of the snacks were about to expire and we didn't like them at all! However, I could not return it and the shopkeeper did not let me (4) (get) a refund. We couldn't even share them with our friends, because they tasted so bad!

Claudia

Two years ago, I went to Marine Park with my family because I got 100 marks in my English exam. I brought my remaining red packet money with me – I had \$200 left. All of the items at the shop were appealing, but I didn't have enough money to buy them all. At last, I chose the largest mystery bag at the counter. Little did I know that it would be a big disappointment. It turned out (5) (be) a frightening clown instead of a cute dolphin. I was told (6) (think) more carefully in future before making a purchase.

Natalie

I regret (7) (lend) some of my lai see to my friend. We wanted to buy our friend a present, but Andy said he did not have enough money. I agreed to pay for him and he promised to give me the money back soon. However, it has been two months and I have yet to (8) (get) my money back. He keeps (9) (give) me all sorts of excuses and he is now trying to avoid me. From then on, I swore to myself not (10) (lend) money to anyone.

Hugo

1.	2.	3.
4.	5.	6.
7.	8.	9.
10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

F. Multiple-choice Cloze (10 marks)

Read the following text. Decide which of the choices would best complete the text if inserted in the blanks. Write the **letter** of each answer in the space provided.

Information gold mines

(1) information, most people will 'Google' or look on Wikipedia. These are, (2), convenient and effective research tools. But they only give you basic information. To get (3) results, you need to go further. For this purpose, there are many sources you may consult.

To begin with, your presentations and articles must be well-researched and grounded in facts. Libraries can help you do that. Apart from print books and films, you (4) also find online books and professional journals in libraries. Also, a 'Multimedia Information' mobile app (5) recently to enable users to access digitised content, including e-books, images and audio-visual materials in libraries.

Hong Kong has (6) public museums on different subjects where you can find relics and exhibits to enrich your research. Apart from the Hong Kong Museum of History, the Hong Kong Heritage Discovery Centre at Kowloon Park is also a good place to explore local history. The centre is housed in two 1910 buildings of the former Whitefield Barracks.

Besides, you may go off the (7) track. Visit a private museum and get information that few people know about. There are a number of private museums on different subjects in Hong Kong. (8), the Hong Kong Museum of Medical Sciences at 2 Caine Lane, Mid-Levels, charts the development of medical science in Hong Kong.

The Hong Kong Film Archive at Lei King Road in Sai Wan Ho is dedicated to the collection, (9) and screening of Hong Kong films and other related materials. Its resource centre houses film-related publications and audio-visual materials for on-site public reference. It is a good source of information for projects (10) cultural subjects.

1. A. Finding B. To find C. Find D. Found	2. A. in doubt B. no doubt C. doubtful D. doubtedly	3. A. gooder B. badder C. better D. worse
4. A. must B. need to C. ought to D. can	5. A. is launched B. are launched C. was launched D. were launched	6. A. a number of B. plenty C. a lots of D. some of
7. A. beated B. beaten C. bitten D. biten	8. A. For instances B. On the contrary C. On the other hand D. For example	9. A. preservation B. preserving C. preserved D. preserve
10. A. in B. on C. at D. for		

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

G. Sentence Transformation (10 marks)

Rewrite the following sentences as instructed without changing the meaning.

1. Oliver said, "I haven't finished my homework yet." (Use reported speech)

2. "You stole the money," Ben said to Polly. (Use reported speech with the reporting verb "accuse")

3. I'm reading a book. The book is written by Rachel Brown. (Rewrite using a relative pronoun)

4. It is a small teapot. Only one cup of tea can be made at a time. (Combine the sentences using "such")

5. Tammy broke the precious vase last night. (Rewrite the sentence in the opposite voice)

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

H. Proofreading (10 marks)

Proofread the following text (numbered lines 1-10 only) without changing the meaning. No lines have more than one mistake and at least one line is correct. Do not make any changes to punctuation and do not make unnecessary changes. Use ONE word only for each correction. If you think there are no mistakes in a line, put a ✓ at the end of the line (example c).

Corrections must be done as follows:

Extra word: delete the extra word with a 'X' (example a).

Missing word: mark the position of the missing word with a '^' and write the missing word above it (example b).

Wrong word: underline the wrong word and write the correct word above it (example d).

a	When I was younger, my friends and I would X try to scare each other
b	by telling ghost stories. I never got frightened because I did not believe ^ ghosts.
c	In fact, I would laugh at anyone who said they did. However, I changed my ✓
d	mind about this last summer when I was staying <u>at</u> my aunt in Guangzhou.

1	If it was your last chance to talk to your love ones, what would you say?
2	The Last Lecture is a book based on actual lecture given by computer science professor Randy
3	Pausch at Carnegie Mellon University. He had been diagnosed of terminal pancreatic cancer and
4	only had a few months of life left. As his time was running out and he knew that his children were too
5	young now to understand, Pausch came up with the idea that he could tell his stories though his 'last
6	lecture'. The idea was that, years after his dead, his children would be able to 'see' and 'hear' him again
7	and learn more about himself through the recording of his lecture. In his lecture, Pausch shared his ideas
8	on how people can achieve their dreams, and illustrated this with examples from his own life.
9	Pausch's sincere and great sense of humour make his lecture lively and heart-warming. His lecture
10	was videotaped and uploaded to the internet. It was viewed over a million time.

END OF PAPER

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.